


FREE READER BONUS

# The Flavor *Matrix*

Mix and match fats, flavors, and finishing touches to develop your own candle combinations.

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Base, star, friend, and finishing touch, with how much of each to use.

02 **Choose Your Fat** p. 3
Butter, ghee, coconut oil, bacon fat, and more: what each one brings.

03 **The Matrix** p. 4
68 flavor pairings from the book, by family, with page numbers.

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Test three ideas from one cup of butter, and keep notes on the winners.




A COMPANION TO

## The Edible Candles Cookbook

Every pairing in this matrix comes from a recipe in the book; page numbers point you right to it.

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BUILD YOUR FLAVOR

# The Formula

*Every candle in the book follows the same simple logic. Once you know it, you can turn almost any idea into a candle.*

**BASE**
**1 cup solid fat, softened**
Butter is the classic. Ghee, plant-based butter, bacon fat, or refined coconut oil work too, cup for cup.

+

**STAR**
**The flavor people notice first**
Garlic, honey, cinnamon, lemon, smoked paprika

+

**FRIEND**
**What makes the star shine**
Thyme with honey, chili with lime, cardamom with orange

+

**FINISHING TOUCH**
**A little something on the outside**
Flaky salt, a little zest, a few pressed herbs

**Keep it simple**
Two or three flavors that love each other almost always beat a long list.

## HOW TO USE THE MATRIX

- Pick a **star** you love, then look across its row for **friends** and a **finishing touch**.
- Every row comes from a recipe in the book. The first time, follow that recipe exactly; it already has the amounts, the mold, and the wick.
- Then make it yours: swap one friend for another from the same family, change the finishing touch, or move the star to a different fat.
- The *Pairings at a Glance* page shows which friends turn up with which stars across the whole book.

## MEASURE IT RIGHT

Amounts per 1 cup of fat. The fat is what burns, and the flavors come along for the ride, so these limits keep the flame happy.

| INGREDIENT | HOW MUCH | GOOD TO KNOW |
|---|---|---|
| **Freeze-dried fruit** | About ¼ cup, crushed to a powder | Instead of fresh fruit or juice: water makes the flame sputter. |
| **Citrus** | The zest only | The recipes use from 1 tsp of zest up to the zest of 2 limes. No juice. |
| **Fresh herbs** | About 2 tbsp, finely chopped | Pat them dry. Dried herbs work beautifully too. |
| **Wet extras** | The recipes use 1 tbsp to ¼ cup | Capers, olives, sun-dried tomatoes: pat them dry and chop them small. |
| **Honey, maple, caramel** | About 2 tbsp | Go easy on sweet and sticky. Powdered sugar blends in more smoothly than granulated. |
| **Ground spices** | The recipes use ¼ to 2 tsp | Strong ones like cayenne stay at the low end. |
| **Extracts** | The recipes use ¼ to 1 tsp | Use an extract, like bourbon or rum, never liquor. |
| **Chocolate** | ¾ cup (170 g) butter + 4 oz (113 g) chocolate | Cool the melted chocolate until barely warm before you beat it in. |
| **Cheese** | 1 part cheese to 3 parts butter, by weight | For example, ¾ cup (170 g) butter with 2 oz (57 g) cheese. Pat feta or ricotta dry; skip cheeses so ripe they're runny. Always use the Cheese Wick. |
| **Brie in its rind** | About half and half | The one exception to the cheese ratio. |

**Keep the top clear**
Pressed herbs, flowers, seeds, and crusts look lovely on the sides. Leave the top plain around the wick.

BUILD YOUR FLAVOR

# Choose Your Fat

*Every fat brings its own character. Measure by the cup, not by weight: they weigh a little differently.*

| FAT | BEST WITH | GOOD TO KNOW | TRY IT IN |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Unsalted butter**<br>Creamy and mild | Almost anything, sweet or savory | The classic. Chocolate and cheese candles always start with butter. | Most recipes in the book |
| **Salted butter**<br>Creamy, already seasoned | Hot honey, everything bagel seasoning, bacon | The recipes that use it add no extra salt. | Hot Honey & Chili p. 28<br>Bacon & Chive p. 40 |
| **Brown butter**<br>Toasty and nutty | Sage, black pepper | Browned first, then set again: follow the recipe. | Brown Butter & Sage p. 32 |
| **Ghee**<br>Rich and nutty | Whole spices: curry leaves, mustard and cumin seeds, turmeric | It comes from milk, so it isn't dairy-free. | Ghee & Curry Leaf p. 84 |
| **Plant-based butter sticks**<br>Mild, dairy-free | Garlic and herbs, dairy-free dark chocolate | Holds a little more water: keep the wick a bit shorter. Many brands contain soy or nuts. | Plant-Based Garlic Herb p. 85<br>Dairy-Free Dark Chocolate p. 89 |
| **Refined coconut oil**<br>Clean and neutral | Lime, toasted coconut, tropical fruit | Melts quickly: it goes to the table straight from the fridge. | Coconut Lime p. 87 |
| **Bacon fat**<br>Smoky and savory | Black pepper, thyme, smoked paprika | Dairy-free, but not vegan. | Bacon Fat & Black Pepper p. 86 |
| **Olive oil, beaten into butter**<br>Fruity and peppery | Rosemary, lemon peel, garlic confit | It softens the butter, so the candle stays in its ramekin. Garlic or herbs in oil always live in the fridge, for up to 4 days. | Olive Oil & Rosemary p. 82<br>Garlic Confit p. 83 |
| **Cocoa butter**<br>Delicate chocolate aroma | Vanilla, pressed edible flowers | Used with a little coconut oil. No dairy at all. | Cocoa Butter Vanilla p. 88 |

**Prime the wick in the same fat**
For a dairy-free candle, prime the wick in the fat you're using, so it's dairy-free all the way through.

# Star, Friend & Finishing Touch

*Every row is a candle in the book. Follow it once, then mix and match.*

## SAVORY BUTTER

*Start with 1 cup of butter.*

| STAR | FRIENDS | FINISHING TOUCH | TRY IT IN |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Garlic** | Parsley, rosemary, thyme, black pepper | Flaky sea salt | Garlic & Herb Butter Candle p. 26 |
| **Garlic** | Parsley, chives, thyme (plant-based butter) | Flaky sea salt | Plant-Based Garlic Herb Candle p. 85 |
| **Roasted garlic** | Parmesan, thyme, black pepper | Whole roasted cloves on the sides | Roasted Garlic & Parmesan Butter Candle p. 27 |
| **Hot honey** | Red pepper flakes, smoked paprika | Hot honey drizzled around the base | Hot Honey & Chili Butter Candle p. 28 |
| **Chili crisp** | Scallion | — | Chili Crisp Butter Candle p. 29 |
| **Chipotle** | Lime zest, cilantro, smoked paprika | A ring of lime zest and paprika | Smoky Chipotle Lime Butter Candle p. 33 |
| **Buffalo hot sauce** | Garlic powder, smoked paprika, celery salt | — | Game Day Buffalo Candle p. 102 |
| **Sun-dried tomato** | Basil, oregano, garlic | — | Sun-Dried Tomato & Basil Butter Candle p. 31 |
| **Brown butter** | Sage, black pepper | Whole sage leaves on the sides | Brown Butter & Sage Candle p. 32 |
| **Black pepper** | Pecorino Romano | A peppery rind | Black Pepper & Pecorino Butter Candle p. 34 |
| **Caramelized onion** | Thyme, black pepper | — | Caramelized Onion & Thyme Butter Candle p. 35 |
| **Lemon zest** | Dill, capers | Dill sprigs and whole capers | Lemon, Dill & Caper Butter Candle p. 36 |
| **Miso** | Scallion, white pepper | Scallion greens around the base | Miso & Scallion Butter Candle p. 37 |
| **Basil pesto** | Flaky sea salt | Basil leaves on the sides | Basil Pesto Butter Candle p. 38 |
| **Za'atar** | Kalamata olives, lemon zest | Green olive halves on the sides | Za'atar & Olive Butter Candle p. 39 |
| **Everything bagel seasoning** | Chives | A seasoning crust | Everything Bagel Butter Candle p. 30 |
| **Bacon** | Chives, smoked paprika, black pepper | Bacon and chives on the sides | Bacon & Chive Butter Candle p. 40 |
| **Truffle** | Sea salt, black pepper | A glossy drip | Truffle & Sea Salt Butter Candle p. 41 |
| **Parmesan** | Garlic powder, Italian seasoning | A ring of torn bread | Herb Butter & Bread Centerpiece p. 104 |
| **Sage** | Dried cranberries, thyme, black pepper | A band of whole cranberries | Thanksgiving Sage & Cranberry Candle p. 91 |

## SWEET BUTTER

*Start with 1 cup of butter.*

| STAR | FRIENDS | FINISHING TOUCH | TRY IT IN |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Honey** | Thyme | Pressed thyme sprigs | Honey & Thyme Butter Candle p. 43 |
| **Honey** | Cinnamon, brown sugar | Ribbons of spice | Cinnamon Honey Butter Candle p. 44 |
| **Honey** | Lavender | — | Lavender Honey Butter Candle p. 50 |
| **Maple syrup** | Pecans, flaky sea salt | A pecan crust | Maple Pecan Butter Candle p. 45 |
| **Vanilla bean** | Powdered sugar | — | Vanilla Bean Butter Candle p. 46 |
| **Vanilla** | Powdered sugar | Sprinkles on the sides | Birthday Cake Candle p. 101 |
| **Freeze-dried strawberry** | Rose water | Rose petals around the plate | Strawberry Rose Butter Candle p. 47 |
| **Freeze-dried strawberry** | Vanilla | Heart sprinkles | Valentine's Strawberry Heart Candle p. 97 |
| **Freeze-dried blueberry** | Lemon zest | A piped swirl, like frosting | Blueberry Lemon Butter Candle p. 51 |
| **Strawberry and blueberry** | Vanilla | Red, white, and blue stripes | Fourth of July Berry Candle p. 100 |
| **Orange zest** | Cardamom | An orange slice alongside | Cardamom Orange Butter Candle p. 48 |
| **Brown sugar** | Bourbon extract, flaky sea salt | — | Brown Sugar & Bourbon Butter Candle p. 49 |
| **Caramel sauce** | Flaky sea salt | A caramel drip | Salted Caramel Butter Candle p. 52 |
| **Cookie butter** | Crushed spiced cookies | — | Cookie Butter Candle p. 53 |
| **Apple butter** | Apple pie spice, brown sugar | Apple chips around the sides | Apple Pie Spice Butter Candle p. 54 |
| **Cinnamon sugar** | Vanilla | Rolled inside vanilla butter | Brunch Cinnamon Roll Candle p. 103 |
| **Molasses** | Ginger, cinnamon, cloves | A powdered sugar snowflake | Gingerbread Candle p. 93 |
| **Pumpkin** | Pumpkin pie spice, brown sugar, vanilla | A real little pumpkin as the holder | Pumpkin Spice Candle p. 92 |
| **Carrot** | Cinnamon, nutmeg, brown sugar | A coconut and walnut nest | Easter Carrot Cake Candle p. 99 |
| **Champagne syrup** | Honey, vanilla | Edible gold sprinkles | New Year's Champagne Butter Candle p. 96 |

## CHOCOLATE

*Start with ¾ cup (170 g) butter and 4 oz (113 g) chocolate.*

| STAR | FRIENDS | FINISHING TOUCH | TRY IT IN |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Dark chocolate** | Flaky sea salt | — | Dark Chocolate & Sea Salt Candle p. 56 |
| **Dark chocolate** | Espresso, cinnamon | Whole coffee beans | Mocha Espresso Chocolate Candle p. 59 |
| **Dark chocolate** | Orange zest | Candied orange slices on the sides | Orange Dark Chocolate Candle p. 62 |
| **Dark chocolate** | Ancho chili, cinnamon, cayenne | — | Chili Chocolate Candle p. 64 |
| **Dark chocolate** | Dried tart cherries | Toasted almonds on the sides | Cherry Almond Chocolate Candle p. 66 |
| **Dark chocolate** | Toasted coconut | Coconut on the sides | Coconut Dark Chocolate Candle p. 67 |
| **Dark chocolate** | Pumpkin pie spice | Cookie-crumb "dirt" and pepitas | Halloween Pumpkin-Spice Chocolate Candle p. 98 |
| **Dark chocolate (dairy-free)** | Plant-based butter | — | Dairy-Free Dark Chocolate Candle p. 89 |
| **Semisweet chocolate** | Soft caramels, flaky sea salt | A caramel ring seen through the glass | Salted Caramel Chocolate Candle p. 65 |
| **Milk chocolate** | Hazelnuts | Hazelnuts on the sides | Milk Chocolate Hazelnut Candle p. 57 |
| **Milk chocolate** | Peanut butter | Peanuts and salt around the base | Peanut Butter Cup Chocolate Candle p. 63 |
| **Milk chocolate** | Graham cracker crust | Graham cracker pieces | S'mores Chocolate Candle p. 60 |
| **Milk and white chocolate** | Chai spice | A white chocolate swirl | Chocolate Chai Candle p. 69 |
| **White chocolate** | Freeze-dried raspberry | A pink swirl | White Chocolate Raspberry Candle p. 58 |
| **White chocolate** | Pistachio, rose, cardamom | — | Pistachio White Chocolate Candle p. 68 |
| **White chocolate** | Peppermint | Red stripes on the sides | Candy Cane White Chocolate Candle p. 95 |
| **Dark and white chocolate** | Peppermint | — | Mint Chocolate Candle p. 61 |
| **Dark and white chocolate** | Peppermint, candy canes | — | Peppermint Bark Candle p. 94 |

## CHEESE

*Start with about 1 part cheese to 3 parts butter, by weight, and always use the Cheese Wick.*

| STAR | FRIENDS | FINISHING TOUCH | TRY IT IN |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Feta** | Honey, lemon zest, thyme | — | Whipped Feta & Honey Cheese Candle p. 71 |
| **Goat cheese** | Garlic, black pepper | A crust of chives, dill, and parsley | Herbed Goat Cheese Candle p. 72 |
| **Brie, in its rind** | Orange zest, cranberry sauce, rosemary | — | Brie & Cranberry Cheese Candle p. 73 |
| **Blue brie, in its rind** | Fig jam, thyme, black pepper | — | Blue Cheese & Fig Candle p. 74 |
| **Smoked Gouda** | Smoked paprika, garlic powder | — | Smoked Gouda Butter Candle p. 75 |
| **Parmesan** | Rosemary, lemon zest, black pepper | — | Parmesan & Rosemary Cheese Candle p. 76 |
| **Cream cheese** | Green onion, garlic powder | An everything-seasoning crust | Everything Cream Cheese Candle p. 77 |
| **Ricotta** | Lemon zest, black pepper | — | Lemon Ricotta Cheese Candle p. 78 |
| **Cheddar** | Pimentos, cayenne | — | Pimento Cheese Candle p. 79 |
| **Cheddar** | Jalapeño, cilantro, garlic powder | Shredded cheddar on the sides | Cheddar & Jalapeño Butter Candle p. 80 |

**Cheese doesn't burn**
The butter is the fuel, so cheese candles need a thicker wick: the Cheese Wick, three strands twisted together before priming (Step 1 of The Method). Trim it to about 1 in before lighting.

# Pairings at a Glance

*Which friends show up with which stars across the book. The numbers are the pages of the recipes that pair them.*

| | Thyme | Rosemary | Soft herbs | Black pepper | Smoked paprika | Warm spices | Nuts & seeds | Coconut | Berries & cherries | Citrus zest | Flaky salt |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Garlic | 26 27 83 85 | 26 | 26 31 77 80 85 | 26 27 72 83 | 75 102 | | | | | | 26 31 83 85 104 |
| Honey | 43 71 | | | | 28 | 44 | | | | 71 | 43 |
| Lemon | 71 | 76 82 | 36 | 76 78 | | | | | 51 | | 36 78 82 |
| Orange | | 73 | | | | 48 | | | 73 | | 73 |
| Lime | | | 33 | | 33 | | | 87 | | | |
| Chili & heat | | 82 | 29 33 80 | | 28 33 102 | 64 | | | | 33 82 | 82 |
| Cinnamon | | | | | | 93 99 | 99 | 99 | | | |
| Maple | | | | | | | 45 | | | | 45 |
| Vanilla | | | | | | 92 103 | | | 97 100 | | |
| Dark chocolate | | | | | | 59 64 98 | 66 98 | 67 | 66 | 62 | 56 65 |
| Milk chocolate | | | | | | 69 | 57 63 | | | | 63 |
| White chocolate | | | | | | 68 69 | 68 | | 58 | | |
| Parmesan & Pecorino | 27 | 76 | | 27 34 76 105 | | | | | | 76 | 104 |
| Cheddar | | | 80 | | | | | | | | |

*An empty square isn't a "no", just a pairing the book doesn't use yet. Flaky salt and warm spices are the friends that pair with the most stars.*

YOUR TURN

# Try It Small

*Not sure about a new idea? Split one cup of butter into three small 4 oz paper cups and try a different flavor in each.*

- Follow The Method exactly as you would for any recipe, with a primed wick in each cup.
- Label the cups, so you know which is which once they're out of the fridge.
- Light them side by side, taste, and compare. If something doesn't go as planned, the Fix-It Guide is there to help.

## Cup 1

**FAT**

**STAR**

**FRIEND**

**FINISHING TOUCH**

**HOW IT LIT**

**HOW IT TASTED**

☐ Make it again
☐ Tweak it
☐ Skip it

## Cup 2

**FAT**

**STAR**

**FRIEND**

**FINISHING TOUCH**

**HOW IT LIT**

**HOW IT TASTED**

☐ Make it again
☐ Tweak it
☐ Skip it

## Cup 3

**FAT**

**STAR**

**FRIEND**

**FINISHING TOUCH**

**HOW IT LIT**

**HOW IT TASTED**

☐ Make it again
☐ Tweak it
☐ Skip it

**Found a winner?**
Write it up on one of your My Candle Cards, so the recipe is ready for your next gathering.